

山西大学 2016-2017 学年第一学期期末考试

大学英语

(完卷时间: 120 分钟 满分: 150 分)

第 I 卷

I. Listening Comprehension

Section A

Directions: In Section A, you will hear ten short conversations between two speakers. At the end of each conversation, a question will be asked about what was said. The conversations and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a conversation and the question about it, read the four possible answers on your paper, and decide which one is the best answer to the question you have heard.

1. A. 4:45. B. 5:15. C. 5:30. D. 5:45.
2. A. At home. B. In a restaurant. C. In a car. D. On the street.
3. A. Colleagues. B. Husband and wife.
C. Employer and employee. D. Mother and son.
4. A. Listening to some loud music. B. Testing the earphones.
C. Talking loudly on the phone. D. Preparing for the speech contest.
5. A. Pick up his son from school. B. Meet the woman in her office.
C. Work on a report. D. Prepare dinner for his son.
6. A. She discussed the sports program with Mr. Wright.
B. She is about to call Mr. Wright's secretary.
C. She will see Mr. Wright at lunch time.
D. She failed to reach Mr. Wright.
7. A. To find out more about the topic for the conference.
B. To make a copy of the schedule for his friend.
C. To get the conference schedule for the woman.
D. To pick up the woman from the library.
8. A. It can stand any crash. B. It is not as good as hers.
C. It was once damaged. D. It is kept in good condition.
9. A. Continue to read. B. Take a history lesson.
C. Have some coffee. D. Meet with some friends.
10. A. More sleep can get the man back onto the right track.
B. Tiredness is a typical symptom of lack of exercise.
C. The man should spend more time outdoors.
D. People tend to work longer hours with artificial lighting.

Section B

Directions: In Section B, you will hear two short passages, and you will be asked three questions on each of the passages. The passages will be read twice, but the questions will be spoken only once. When you hear a question, read the four possible answers on your paper and decide which one would be the best answer to the question you have heard.

Questions 11 through 13 are based on the following passage.

11. A. It is located in a college town. B. It's composed of a group of old buildings.
C. The classrooms are beautifully designed. D. The library is often crowded with students.
12. A. 18,000. B. 1,800. C. 24. D. 9,000.
13. A. Teachers there needn't pay for their rent.
B. There is not even a television set on campus.
C. Students can take a walk in the desert in their spare time.
D. Students have no choice but to study and take up challenges.

Questions 14 through 16 are based on the following passage.

14. A. To take medicine. B. To sleep more.
C. To work less. D. To go travelling.
15. A. They are not harmful to the brain. B. They have more benefits than harm.
C. They are not worth the price at all. D. They are valuable but costly.
16. A. They damage a person's mental health.
B. They reduce a person's chance of recovery.
C. They slow down a person's reaction to changes.
D. They worsen a person's existing trouble.

Section C

Directions: In Section C, you will hear two longer conversations. The conversations will be read twice. After you hear each conversation, you are required to fill in the numbered blanks with the information you have heard. Write your answers on your answer sheet.

Blanks 17 through 20 are based on the following conversation.

Where will the parcel be sent?	__17__.
How heavy is the parcel?	850 __18__.
How will the parcel be sent?	By __19__.
How much is the postage?	__20__ dollars.

Complete the form. Write **ONE WORD** for each answer.

Blanks 21 through 24 are based on the following conversation.

ORDER	
Main Course	__21__
Appetizer	__22__
Soup	split pea
Side Dish	__23__
Drink	__24__

Complete the form. Write **NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS** for each answer.

II. Grammar and Vocabulary

Section A

Directions: After reading the passages below, fill in the blanks to make the passages coherent and grammatically correct. For the blanks with a given word, fill in each blank with the proper form of the given word; for the other blanks, use one word that best fits each blank.

(A)

“Come in, Kim. Have a seat, please,” said Bill Williams, the manager. This was Kim’s first experience with an assessment. After only six months he was due for a raise (25) _____ this assessment was satisfactory.

“Kim,” began Bill Williams, “I am very pleased with the quality of your work. My only concern is that you are not active enough in (26) _____ (put) forward your suggestions.”

“But,” replied Kim, “I have always completed every assignment you (27) _____ (give) me, Mr. Williams.”

“I know that, Kim. And please, call me Bill. But (28) _____ I expect is for you to think independently and introduce new ideas. It is more input from you (29) _____ I need – more feedback on how things are going. I don’t need a ‘yes man’. You just smile (30) _____ everything is fine. I’m not asking you to tell me what to do, but what you think we (31) _____ do. To make suggestions, I employed you because I respect your experience in this field.”

“Yes, I see. I’m not accustomed to this, but I will try to do as you say... Bill.”

“Good, then, I expect (32) _____ (hear) more from you at staff meetings or at any other time you want to discuss an idea with me.”

“Yes, of course. Thank you, Mr. Will... Bill.”

(B)

I was the middle child of the three, but there was a gap of five years on either side, and I hardly saw my father before I was eight. For this and (33) _____ reasons I was somewhat lonely. I had the lonely child’s habit of making up stories, and I think from the very start my literary ambitions (34) _____ (mix) up with the feeling of being isolated. I knew that I had a natural ability with words, and I felt that this created a sort of private world where I could get my own back for my failure in everyday life.

However, the quantity of serious writing which I produced all (35) _____ my childhood would not add up to half a dozen pages. I wrote my first poem at the age of four or five, my mother (36) _____ (take) it down to dictation. I cannot remember anything about it except that it was about a tiger and (37) _____ tiger had “chair-like teeth”— a good enough expression. At eleven, when the war of 1914-18 broke out, I wrote a poem (38) _____ (print) in the local newspaper later. From time to time, when I was a bit (39) _____ (old), I wrote bad and usually unfinished “nature poems”. I also, about twice, attempted a short story (40) _____ was a failure. That was the total of the would-be serious work that I actually set down on paper during all those years.

Section B

Directions: Complete the following passage by using the words in the box. Each word can only be used once. Note that there is one word more than you need.

A. calming	B. regular	C. doable	D. electronics	E. fuel
F. hook	G. incredibly	H. maintain	I. mindlessly	J. treat
K. weapons				

Here are four simple, healthy and, dare we say, fun ways to help you slim down and stay healthy.

Have your cake ...for breakfast

Aside from being depressing, the way to __41__ weight loss isn't by feeling deprived.

Scientists say that people who started off the day with a __42__ felt fuller and more satisfied, and that led to their sticking with the program as the day went on. Being hungry is no way to start your day, so __43__ up with protein and a mouthful of something sweet. And most of all, enjoy!

Sleep your way to weight loss

Dr. Andrew Caloin, one expert of Mayo Clinic study, is quoted as saying, "If individuals are seeking to maintain a healthy weight or to lose weight, they should seek to get enough sleep on a __44__ basis."

If you find it tricky to wind down at night, turn off the __45__ and engage in relaxing activities, like taking a bath or listening to __46__ music.

Journal to drop pounds

The best __47__ for a dieter? Pen and paper! Women who wrote down everything they ate lost more weight than those who didn't track their food intake. Journaling makes you accountable and more aware of what you're eating, so it makes sense that it'll keep you from __48__ chewing if you aren't actually hungry.

Even a tiny bit of exercise helps your health

Even 20 to 30 minutes of physical activity most days of the weeks (broken up into smaller chunks is fine) reduces your risk for all sorts of physical ills. And even 20 minutes a week can improve your mood. That really stuck with me. It's easy to criticize ourselves or burn out if we make goals that are __49__ hard to achieve, but walking a few times a week is __50__ – and meaningful, too.

III. Reading Comprehension

Section A

Directions: For each blank in the following passages there are four words or phrases marked A, B, C and D. Fill in each blank with the word or phrase that best fits the context.

For many people today, reading is no longer relaxation. To keep up their work they must read letters, reports, trade publications, interoffice communications, not to mention newspapers and magazines; a never-ending flood of words. In getting a job advancing, the ability to read and comprehend __51__ can mean the difference between success and failure. Yet the unfortunate fact is that most of us are __52__ readers. Most of us develop poor reading habits at an early age, and never __53__ them. The main shortage lies in the actual stuff of language itself – words. Taken individually, words have little __54__ until they are strung together into phrases, sentences and paragraphs. Unfortunately, __55__, the untrained reader does not read groups of words. He laboriously read one word at a time, often regressing to __56__ words or passages. Regression, the tendency to look back over what you have just read, is a common __57__ habit in reading. Another bad habit which __58__ the speed of reading is vocalization – sounding each word either __59__ or mentally as one reads.

To overcome these bad habits, some reading clinics use a device called an accelerator, which moves a bar (or curtain) down the page at a predetermined speed. The bar is set a slightly __60__ rate than the reader finds comfortable, in order to " __61__ " him. The accelerator forces the reader to read fast, making word-by-word reading, regression and sub-vocalization, practically __62__. At first comprehension is __63__ speed. But when you learn to read ideas and concepts, you will not only read faster, but your comprehension will improve. Many people have found their reading skill __64__ improved after some training. Take Charles Au, a business manager, for instance, his reading rate was a reasonably good 172 words a minute before the training, now it is an excellent 1,378 words a minute. He is delighted that now he can go through a lot more reading material in a(n) __65__ period of time.

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|----------------|-------------|---------------|------------|
| 51. A. quickly | B. silently | C. thoroughly | D. vaguely |
| 52. A. casual | B. curious | C. efficient | D. poor |

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- | | | | |
|---------------------|-----------------|-------------------|--------------------|
| 53. A. acquire | B. cultivate | C. kick | D. practice |
| 54. A. formation | B. meaning | C. pronunciation | D. transformation |
| 55. A. however | B. moreover | C. somehow | D. therefore |
| 56. A. recite | B. reread | C. reuse | D. rewrite |
| 57. A. horrible | B. incurable | C. social | D. viewing |
| 58. A. achieves | B. gains | C. measures | D. reduces |
| 59. A. orally | B. physically | C. quietly | D. repeatedly |
| 60. A. better | B. faster | C. lower | D. steadier |
| 61. A. distract | B. embarrass | C. interest | D. stretch |
| 62. A. demanding | B. impossible | C. reasonable | D. useful |
| 63. A. applied to | B. matched with | C. sacrificed for | D. substituted for |
| 64. A. dramatically | B. hardly | C. slightly | D. subconsciously |
| 65. A. indefinite | B. lengthy | C. limited | D. set |

Section B

Directions: Read the following three passages. Each passage is followed by several questions or unfinished statements. For each of them there are four choices marked A, B, C and D. Choose the one that fits best according to the information given in the passage you have just read.

(A)

Jane Austen was born in the English countryside more than 200 years ago. She lived a simple life. She seldom travelled. She never married and she died from illness when she was only 41.

However, people all over the world remember her. Why? It is because Jane Austen is the author of some of the best-loved novels in the English language. These novels include *Emma*, *Pride and Prejudice*, *Sense and Sensibility* and *Persuasion*.

Jane completed her last novel *Persuasion* in 1816, but it was not published until after her death. *Persuasion* is partly based on Jane's naval brother.

Anne, the daughter of Sir Walter Elliot, falls in love with Captain Wentworth, a person of a lower social position. But she breaks off the engagement when persuaded by her friend Lady Russell that such a match is unworthy. The breakup produces in Anne a deep and long-lasting regret. Eight years later, Wentworth returns from sea a rich and successful captain. He finds Anne's family on the edge of financial ruin. Anne and the captain rediscover their love and get married.

Jane Austen once compared her writing to painting on a little bit of ivory (象牙), two inches square. Readers of *Persuasion* will see that neither her skill of delicate, ironic(讽刺的) observations on social custom, love, and marriage nor her ability to apply a sharp focus to English manners and morals has abandoned her in her final finished work.

Persuasion has produced three film adaptations: a 1995 version starring Amanda Root and Ciaran Hinds, a 2007 TV miniseries with Sally Hawkins and Rupert Penry-Jones, and a 1971 miniseries with Ann Firkbank and Bryan Marshall.

People who are interested in Jane Austen can still visit many of the places she visited and lived. These places include the village of Steventon, although her family house is now gone. Many of the places Jane visited in Bath are still there. You can visit Jane Austen's home in Chawton, where she did her best writing, and Winchester, where she died.

66. What is the theme of *Persuasion*?

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- A. Never regret what you've chosen. B. True love lasts forever.
C. Be matched for marriage. D. Love waits for no man.
67. Which of the following CANNOT describe Jane's writing style?
A. Her application of symbolism. B. Her delicate observations.
C. Her focus on manners and morals. D. Her use of irony.
68. Which of the following about Jane Austen is TRUE?
A. Her family house is now in the village of Steventon.
B. Many of the places she visited in Bath are still available.
C. The latest film adaptation of *Persuasion* was produced in 1995.
D. Her last novel *Persuasion* is considered her most successful one.
69. The article mainly talks about _____.
A. Jane Austen's unique writing style
B. the original residence of Jane Austen
C. Jane Austen's last novel: *Persuasion*
D. the popularity of Jane Austen's novels

(B)

GETTING A GRANT

Who pays?

The local education authority (LEA) for the area in which the student is living.

Who can get this money?

Anyone who gets a place on a first degree course, although a student who has already attended a course of advanced further education may not. Students must also have been resident in the UK for at least three years, which can exclude some students from overseas.

SPECIAL CASES

If a student has worked before going to college?

A student who is 26 or more before the course starts and who has worked for at least three of the previous six years will get extra money – £155 a year if 26, increasing to a maximum of £615 at 29 or more.

If a student is handicapped?

LEAs will give up to £500 to help meet extra expenses – such as buying a tape recorder for a blind student, extra heating or special food.

Banking?

Most of the big banks offer special services to students who open accounts (in the hope that they will stay with the bank when they become rich officials). A student won't usually have to pay bank charges as long as the account stays in credit. Some banks allow students to overdraw by £100 or so, and still don't make charges (though they do charge interest).

70. The phrase "a grant" in the first line most probably means _____.
A. bank interest B. a credit card C. an education fee D. financial aid
71. A student from Japan who has been studying in England for a year and intends to go to college in a few months will _____.
A. be unable to get money from any LEA

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- B. get money if taking a first degree course
C. get money from LEA when finishing his course
D. have to open a bank account before getting money
72. A 31-year-old nurse wishes to qualify as a doctor at a university. She has worked since she was 25. How much extra money will she get a year?
A. None. B. £155. C. £615. D. £515.
73. A big bank offers a new student special services because _____.
A. they need student accounts badly
B. they charge students extra interest
C. they know he can get money regularly
D. they hope he'll be a potential customer

(C)

Publicity offers several benefits. There are not costs for message time or space. An ad in prime-time television may cost \$250,000 to \$5,000,000 or more per minute, whereas a five-minute report on a network newscast would not cost anything. Publicity reaches a mass audience within a short time and new products or company policies are widely known.

Credibility about messages is high, because they are reported in independent media. A newspaper review of a movie has more believability than an ad in the same paper, because the reader associates independence with objectivity. Similarly, people are more likely to pay attention to news reports than to ads. For example, *Women's Wear Daily* has both fashion reports and advertisements. Readers spend time reading the stories, but they skim through the ads. Furthermore, there may be 10 commercials during a half-hour television program or hundreds of ads in a magazine. Feature stories are much fewer in number and stand out clearly.

Publicity also has some significant limitations. A firm has little control over messages, their timing, their placement, or their coverage by a given medium. It may issue detailed news releases and find only portions mentioned by the media, and media have the ability to be much more critical than a firm would like.

For example, in 1982, Procter & Gamble faced a massive publicity problem over the meaning of its 123-year-old company logo. To fight this negative publicity, the firm had a spokesperson appear on *Good Morning America* to disprove the rumor (谣言). The false rumors were temporarily put to rest. However, in 1985, publicity became so troublemaking that Procter & Gamble decided to remove the logo from its products.

A firm may want publicity during certain periods, such as when a new product is introduced or new store opened, but the media may not cover the introduction or opening until after the time it would aid the firm. Similarly, media determine the placement of a story; it may follow a report on crime or sports. Finally, the media decide whether to cover a story at all and the amount of coverage to be devoted to it.

74. All of the following advantages of publicity are mentioned **EXCEPT** _____.
A. time saving B. attentiveness C. credibility D. profitability
75. Compared with ad, news report or featuring stories are more _____.
A. believable B. clear C. dependent D. subjective
76. The example of "Procter & Gamble" is given to show _____.
A. the efficient way of disproving rumors B. the importance of a spokesperson
C. the interaction between firms and media D. the negative effect of publicity
77. What's the author's attitude towards publicity?
A. doubtful B. objective C. passive D. supportive

Section C

Directions: Read the passage carefully. Then answer the questions or complete the statements in the fewest possible words.

The motor vehicle has killed and disabled more people in its brief history than any bomb or weapon ever invented. Much of the blood on the street flows essentially from uncivil behavior of drivers who refuse to respect the legal or moral rights of others. So the massacre (大屠杀) on the road may be regarded as a social problem.

In fact, the enemies of society on wheels are rather harmless people just ordinary people acting carelessly, you might say. But it is a principle both of law and common morality that carelessness is no excuse when one's actions could bring death or damages to others. A minority of the killers go even beyond carelessness to total negligence.

Researchers have estimated that as many as 80 percent of all automobile accidents can be connected with psychological condition of the driver. Emotional upsets can affect drivers' reactions, slow their judgment, and blind them to dangers that might otherwise be evident. The experts warn that it is vital for every driver to make a conscious effort to keep one's emotions under control.

Yet the irresponsibility that accounts for much of the problem is not limited to drivers. Street walkers regularly ignore traffic regulations. They are at fault in most vehicle-walker accidents; and many cyclists even believe that they are not subject to the basic rules of the road.

In the past few years, safety standards for vehicle have been raised both at the point of manufacture and through periodic road-worthiness inspections. In addition, speed limits have been lowered. Due to these measures, the accident rate has decreased. But the accident experts still worry because there has been little or no improvement in the way drivers behave. The only real and lasting solution, say the experts, is to convince people that driving is a skilled task requiring constant care and concentration. Those who fail to do all these things present a threat to those with whom they share the road.

(Note: Answer the questions or complete the statements in **NO MORE THAN TEN WORDS**.)

78. Why road killers can't be excused? Because _____.
79. In order to avoid automobile accidents, the experts suggest drivers should _____.
80. Besides drivers, who should also be blamed for most roads accidents?
81. The accident rate has decreased in the past few years because of _____.

第 II 卷

I. Translation

Directions: Translate the following sentences into English, using the words given in the brackets.

- 他总是不懂装懂。(pretend)
- 他没有参加这次面试,这使他失去了一份薪水丰厚的工作。(which)
- 相对而言,污染带来的威胁比疾病更加严重。(threat)
- 很多边远村学校没有图书馆,以致一些孩子没有读过课本以外的任何书籍。(available)
- 他到美国呆了一段时间后,才知道之前他对这个国家的了解是何等肤浅。(Only)

II. Guided Writing

Directions: Write an English composition in over 120 words according to the instructions given below in Chinese.

某国际青少年互动友谊营正在招募志愿者,要求能安排并接待一位与你年龄相仿的外国青少年在上海游玩一天。你对此很感兴趣,请写一封 E-mail,申请担任志愿者,并告诉主办方你的一天安排。(文中请不要

要出现真实的校名人名)